

Surprise visit: steps for the visiting officer

Order of work on the day
Use with the Surprise Visit Report (sections A–M)

NOTICE TO CENTRE None. Do not phone or message the centre before arrival.	TIME ON SITE 60–90 minutes for 2–3 running courses; add about 10 minutes for each extra course	WHAT IT CHECKS Only what a centre cannot prepare: people present, training running, daily registers	RECORD Surprise Visit Report, web form on phone or paper form
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Preparation in the office (day before or morning of the visit)

#	Task	What to do	Report
P1	Pick the centre and time	Choose a day and hour when the training calendar or TDP shows classes running. Share the plan only with your supervisor.	A
P2	Take lists from TMS	List every course and batch running today, with its enrolled total and female and its shift. Pick 5 enrolled trainees at random for the identity check, spread across the courses, and 5 graduates at random from the job-placed list, with phone numbers.	C, D, J
P3	Read the last visit report	List the issues left open at the last QA, monitoring or surprise visit, so you can check them on site.	K
P4	Get ready to record	Charge the phone, open the web form (it works offline) or carry the paper form, and note the time you leave the office.	—

Order of work at the centre

#	Minutes	Step	What to do	Report
1	0–5	Arrive and note status	- Write the arrival time before you enter. Note from the gate whether the centre is open and training is running. - Introduce yourself to the most senior person present and record who received you. Ask them to stay with you; do not wait in the office for the Principal or for tea. - Ask which room or workshop each course from P2 is using right now and write the room beside the course. A course from P2 with no room is itself a finding.	A, B
2	5–20	Count heads in every room	- Make one quick round of every classroom and workshop in use, for all courses, before anyone touches an attendance register. In each room count trainees (total and female), note the course and whether the trainer is present, then move on. With two officers, split the rooms and start at the same time. - Only after the round, ask for each course's register and today's TMS figure and write all three numbers per course. A gap between headcount, register and TMS is the main finding of this visit.	B, C
3	20–30	Check trainee identity	Call out the 5 names picked from TMS. For each, check the person against the admission form or ID. Ask whether they work at the centre or study in its non-SICIP courses.	D
4	30–45	Observe one session	Sit in one session for about 15 minutes; choose a workshop practical and the course with the largest attendance gap from step 2. Spend 3–5 minutes in the other workshops for tools, PPE and safety. Check CS and CBLM, apron / T-shirt and PPE worn, job sheets, practice share (80:20), tools and consumables in use, fire extinguisher, first aid and safety signs.	E, F
5	45–55	Talk to trainees alone	Ask staff to leave the room. Put the interview questions to a group of trainees drawn from more than one course and record one general answer and any complaint. Do not name the trainees to the centre.	I
6	55–70	Check records	Ask for the latest formative assessment paper and result sheet of one batch (a different course from step 4), the daily consumption register, the stock register and the monitoring logbook. Check each open issue from P3.	G, H, K
7	70–80	Call graduates	Phone the 5 graduates from P2 away from staff. Confirm employer, position and salary. Calls not reached on site can be made the same day from the office.	J
8	80–90	Close the visit	- Tick every critical flag seen, choose the overall rating and write the key findings. - Tell the in-charge what you found and the instructions they must follow; write the instructions in the report and ask them to enter them in the monitoring logbook. Note the departure time.	L, M

Rules on site

- Count people in every room before looking at any paper; registers can be filled in while you wait.
- Visit every room in use, including rooms the centre does not mention; trainees can be moved between rooms.
- Keep the order: people, then training, then records. Records do not change in an hour; attendance does.
- Interview trainees and call graduates with no centre staff present.
- Photograph the register page, the class in session and any flag you tick.
- Give instructions on the spot, but leave the rating and follow-up decision to the report.

After the visit (same or next working day)

- Finish any graduate calls not reached and complete every section of the report.
- Print or save the report as PDF and file it with the centre's visit records.
- If any critical flag is ticked, report it to your supervisor the same day with photos.
- Record the recommended follow-up: none, full QA visit, written explanation from the TI or escalation to the PIU.
- Add the open instructions to the issue list for the next visit to this centre.

TMS = Training Management System, TDP = training delivery plan, CS = competency standard, CBLM = competency-based learning material, PPE = personal protective equipment, PIU = project implementation unit, TI = training institute. Minutes are a guide for a centre with 2–3 running batches.